

Later Wittgenstein — MCQ Questions

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CONTENTS

Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

MCQ 1	3	MCQ 27	8
MCQ 2	3	MCQ 28	9
MCQ 3	3	MCQ 29	9
MCQ 4	3	MCQ 30	9
MCQ 5	4	MCQ 31	9
MCQ 6	4	MCQ 32	10
MCQ 7	4	MCQ 33	10
MCQ 8	4	MCQ 34	10
MCQ 9	4	MCQ 35	10
MCQ 10	5	MCQ 36	11
MCQ 11	5	MCQ 37	11
MCQ 12	5	MCQ 38	11
MCQ 13	5	MCQ 39	11
MCQ 14	6	MCQ 40	11
MCQ 15	6	MCQ 41	12
MCQ 16	6	MCQ 42	12
MCQ 17	6	MCQ 43	12
MCQ 18	6	MCQ 44	12
MCQ 19	7	MCQ 45	13
MCQ 20	7	MCQ 46	13
MCQ 21	7	MCQ 47	13
MCQ 22	7	MCQ 48	13
MCQ 23	8	MCQ 49	13
MCQ 24	8	MCQ 50	14
MCQ 25	8	MCQ 51	14
MCQ 26	8		

MCQ 1

Which account best captures continuity and discontinuity between the early and later Wittgenstein?

A. The concern with language disappears, while a new metaphysical theory of mental objects replaces logical analysis entirely. B. The aim of clarification remains, while one logical form gives way to descriptions of diverse grammatical practices. C. The later work accepts verificationism, while the early work is recast as an empirical psychology of speech. D. The picture theory remains unchanged, while ordinary examples merely illustrate the same elementary propositions.

MCQ 2

Why is the colour-exclusion problem relevant to Wittgenstein's transition after the *Tractatus*?

A. Colour words lack observable instances, proving that all ordinary propositions are metaphysical pseudostatements. B. Colour incompatibility shows that propositions never picture facts, directly establishing the complete later philosophy as a complete semantic account. C. Apparently elementary colour propositions exclude one another, pressuring the early requirement that elementary propositions be logically independent. D. The problem concerns private colour sensations alone, so it first appears within the diary argument of section 258.

MCQ 3

Which provenance statement is accurate for an examination answer on *Philosophical Investigations*?

A. The work appeared posthumously in 1953, with Anscombe and Rhees as editors and Anscombe as translator. B. The work appeared in 1969 as notes on certainty, with Kripke responsible for its English translation. C. The work was a Vienna Circle manifesto jointly issued by Wittgenstein, Schlick and Carnap in 1929. D. Wittgenstein published the completed work in 1921 with Russell's introduction and later withdrew its central thesis.

MCQ 4

A candidate says that later Wittgenstein simply replaced an ideal language with a better ordinary-language theory. What is the best correction?

A. He transferred the Tractarian search for a single calculus to established ordinary usage, but treated that usage as the final explanatory system. B. He kept philosophy's clarificatory aim but rejected one explanatory theory, using case-specific descriptions to dissolve confusion. C. He recast philosophy as an empirical study of verbal conduct, allowing observation to settle the conceptual questions left by logic. D. He treated ordinary conventions as authoritative rules whose stability provides a general theory of linguistic correctness.

MCQ 5

Which ownership statement correctly separates Topic 08 from the two preceding topics?

A. Every question mentioning Wittgenstein belongs to Topic 08, regardless of whether it concerns the Tractatus or Investigations. B. Picture theory is owned by Topic 06 and verificationism by Topic 07, while their contrast with use is cross-linked here. C. The hierarchy of languages question belongs primarily here because later language-games also recognize multiple linguistic practices. D. Verificationism becomes a Later Wittgenstein doctrine because section 353 mentions asking how a proposition may be verified.

MCQ 6

What is the precise force of the qualification in Philosophical Investigations section 43?

A. Every expression means only its statistically most frequent occurrence across all communities and historical periods. B. Only names have meanings, while logical particles and avowals are convenient but strictly meaningless noises. C. In many cases, meaning can be clarified through use, without claiming one universal reduction of meaning. D. Use replaces reference entirely, making it incorrect to say that a proper name ever refers to an individual.

MCQ 7

Why does the toolbox analogy challenge the Augustinian picture of language?

A. A toolbox is a formal calculus whose rules determine every future sentence independently of training and circumstances. B. Tools are useful only when privately imagined, so mental images supply the common foundation of linguistic understanding. C. Every tool has one material bearer, proving that every meaningful expression must name a physical object. D. Different expressions perform different jobs, so naming is one linguistic function rather than the essence of every word.

MCQ 8

A teacher points to two red squares and says 'red'. Why does this not fix the word's meaning by itself?

A. The lesson succeeds chiefly when the sample resembles later red objects closely enough to guide analogical extension. B. Pointing helps, although training must establish whether colour, shape, number, material, position or another role is at issue. C. Pointing becomes determinate once the teacher's private intention selects colour, although the learner may initially misunderstand it. D. The spoken label supplies a self-interpreting rule that fixes the sample as a colour standard rather than as an example of shape or number.

MCQ 9

Which performance most directly displays understanding as mastery of a technique?

A. Experiencing a vivid inner image that no outward performance could ever confirm or disconfirm. B. Continuing a learned series appropriately while responding to correction across relevant new cases. C. Reciting a dictionary sentence without being able to use the expression in any altered circumstance. D. Naming the private mental object that allegedly accompanies every competent utterance of the word.

MCQ 10

How should the word 'Water!' be analysed in later Wittgenstein's method?

A. A relatively stable private image can accompany the word, but that image fixes its speech-act role across changing settings. B. Its primary meaning remains descriptive reference, while requests and warnings are pragmatically shortened descriptions. C. Context lets each speaker negotiate a local meaning, with communal correction entering after the intended use has been formed. D. Its role varies with the language-game but remains answerable to shared practice, as in a request, warning or identification.

MCQ 11

Which formulation best states family resemblance without converting it into a hidden essence?

A. Instances are connected by overlapping and criss-crossing similarities, with no one feature required in every case. B. Instances need no similarities or learned boundaries because any object may belong to any concept at will. C. Every instance shares the single higher-order property of family resemblance, which functions as its real definition. D. A concept is legitimate only when philosophers can state necessary and sufficient conditions for every possible application.

MCQ 12

What does the instruction 'Don't think, but look!' require in the investigation of a concept?

A. Avoid reasoning altogether and replace conceptual inquiry with passive visual observation of physical objects. B. Accept the first familiar definition because ordinary speakers cannot be mistaken about their grammatical practices. C. Survey actual cases and differences before imposing a theoretical essence that usage may not display. D. Search introspection for the mental image shared by every competent user of the disputed expression.

MCQ 13

Why do blurred boundaries not make a family-resemblance concept defective?

A. A blurred concept becomes meaningful only after science discovers the hidden property common to all its instances. B. The absence of sharp boundaries means that correct and incorrect uses can never be distinguished in ordinary practice. C. Training and established applications can guide competent continuation without a sharp essence at every edge. D. Competence requires every speaker to draw exactly the same boundary in every imaginable borderline case.

MCQ 14

How does family resemblance support the claim that language is composed of games?

A. It permits diverse linguistic activities to count as language through overlapping relations rather than one common function. B. It identifies picturing facts as the common feature shared by requests, jokes, prayers, reports and avowals. C. It shows that the term language-game is only decorative because language has a strict essence independently of use, despite actual usage. D. It proves that every linguistic activity is entertaining, competitive and governed by an explicit written rulebook.

MCQ 15

What does Wittgenstein's builders' example establish about a primitive language?

A. A four-word vocabulary is meaningful only if each word silently abbreviates a complete proposition in an ideal language. B. The workers understand because each sound produces the same private image in both minds before any action occurs. C. The example shows that all language-games reduce to issuing commands and obeying them within manual labour. D. A restricted order-and-response practice can be complete for its purpose without being a defective fragment of ordinary speech.

MCQ 16

Which account of language-game rules is most faithful to the later view?

A. Rules may be implicit in training, correction and practice even when no complete written rulebook exists. B. Rules are private interpretations that determine use before any social training or observable correction occurs. C. Calling language a game means speakers may revise meanings individually without standards or consequences. D. A practice counts as a language-game only when all participants can state every governing rule propositionally.

MCQ 17

Why can new language-games arise and old ones disappear without making meaning arbitrary?

A. An innovation acquires meaning when a speaker forms a sufficiently determinate intention and others later infer the intended rule. B. Meanings may change at the margins, although an underlying logical role fixes the core of each expression through historical shifts. C. New games become norm-governed when an institution codifies their rules, with informal usage serving mainly as preliminary experimentation. D. Change occurs within shared techniques and purposes, although uptake and correction still distinguish innovation from failure.

MCQ 18

A speaker uses a familiar sentence as a joke rather than as a report. What follows for its meaning?

A. The sentence retains only its literal report because grammatical surface fixes one function independently of context. B. The joke is meaningless because only propositions that picture facts can participate in a genuine language-game. C. The speaker's unexpressed intention alone fixes the joke even if no practice could distinguish it from a report. D. The surrounding activity and criteria of response help determine its role, so sentence form alone is insufficient.

MCQ 19

Which sequence correctly connects the main later-Wittgenstein concepts?

A. Plural uses support language-games, overlapping relations support family resemblance, and shared practice supports rule-following. B. Verification supports forms of life, forms of life support protocol sentences, and protocols establish private language. C. Private ideas support reference, reference supports logical atomism, and logical atomism supports ordinary-language therapy. D. Aspect-blindness supports ideal notation, ideal notation supports elementary propositions, and these establish public criteria.

MCQ 20

What does the statement 'To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life' primarily assert?

A. A form of life is an explicit set of opinions accepted by majority vote within a linguistic community. B. Language originates in a private imaginative act that subsequently projects meanings onto social behaviour. C. Linguistic intelligibility is inseparable from patterns of activity, reaction, training and shared human life. D. Each natural language embodies a complete metaphysical worldview that outsiders can never understand or criticize.

MCQ 21

How should agreement in form of life be distinguished from agreement in opinion?

A. It is an innate logical structure that functions independently of bodily reactions, training and social practices. B. It concerns shared ways of acting and judging that make particular disagreements and corrections intelligible. C. It means every member accepts identical beliefs, values and theories before communication can begin. D. A statistical majority's current preference determines truth and correctness in every disputed case.

MCQ 22

What is the safest interpretation of the remark that a speaking lion would not be understood?

A. Shared vocabulary may be insufficient when forms of activity and natural reactions are radically different. B. Translation between distinct human cultures is logically impossible because every culture has an inaccessible private grammar. C. Understanding requires identical inner images in speaker and hearer, which a lion could never reproduce. D. Nonhuman animals are physically incapable of producing meaningful sounds under any possible circumstances.

MCQ 23

When justification reaches 'This is simply what I do', what has happened?

A. The community has voted to stop inquiry, making the majority's behaviour logically immune from criticism. B. Reasons have reached the practical bedrock of trained action, not an infallible private intuition or arbitrary preference. C. The speaker has abandoned every standard, so any continuation now counts as equally correct within the game. D. A metaphysical foundation has been discovered beneath practice and can be stated as a final explanatory proposition.

MCQ 24

Which criticism of forms of life is strongest and still fair to Wittgenstein?

A. The notion denies all biological commonality and defines practices solely through consciously negotiated conventions. B. The notion is incoherent because every meaningful sentence must instead picture an atomic fact through logical form. C. The notion is under-specified between natural and cultural readings, creating pressure toward relativism without entailing it. D. The notion proves that criticism across practices is impossible, which Wittgenstein explicitly presents as its main conclusion.

MCQ 25

What generates the rule-following paradox in section 201?

A. Any finite action can be made to fit a rule under some interpretation, so interpretation alone cannot determine correctness. B. No human behaviour displays regularity, so the very idea of repeated or customary action must be abandoned across cases. C. Rules are generally vague sentences, and replacing them with longer sentences always eliminates the problem completely. D. Communities disagree about rules, proving that correct application is whatever the largest group presently approves.

MCQ 26

Why does adding a second rule fail to determine the application of a first rule?

A. The second rule is necessarily written in another natural language and therefore cannot contain any meaningful words. B. Rules can guide action only when a private image accompanies them, and additional wording weakens that image. C. The second rule itself requires application, so an interpretation-based solution merely moves the regress one step. D. A community may recognize only one rule at a time, making combined standards sociologically impossible.

MCQ 27

How does Wittgenstein preserve normativity after rejecting interpretation all the way down?

A. An abstract rule-object causally produces the correct next action independently of learners and circumstances. B. A private feeling of certainty fixes the rule even when no distinction between seeming and being right remains. C. Correct and incorrect continuation are exhibited within trained practices of teaching, correction and going on. D. Every regular sequence is correct simply because it occurs, so normative assessment reduces to behavioural frequency.

MCQ 28

What is the examiner-safe treatment of Kripke's reading of rule-following?

A. Treat community assertibility as Wittgenstein's uncontested doctrine and omit section 201's description of a misunderstanding. B. Reject every secondary interpretation without stating the problem it illuminates or the textual grounds for disagreement. C. Identify Kripke as an editor of Philosophical Investigations whose notes establish the official meaning of its remarks. D. Present the sceptical paradox and community solution as influential and contested, then distinguish them from the textual dissolution.

MCQ 29

Which case would most directly expose the difference between following a rule and merely acting regularly?

A. A learner responds to correction and extends the procedure to unfamiliar cases for reasons recognized within the practice. B. A speaker feels inwardly compelled to continue but cannot identify any circumstance in which the continuation would be wrong. C. A machine repeats an output pattern accidentally, although no distinction between error and correction applies to its operation. D. A crowd produces the same response repeatedly, so numerical convergence alone is treated as sufficient for correctness.

MCQ 30

How does rule-following prepare the critique of private language?

A. Rule-following requires a contemporaneous social check despite allowing a person to execute the rule in physical solitude. B. The problem turns mainly on the diarist's fallible memory, so a reliable mnemonic device would secure the private sign's correctness. C. A sign needs a standard beyond present seeming despite absent observers, and private ostension supplies none. D. Communal agreement constitutes the truth of a rule and thereby determines whether the sensation named by it is present.

MCQ 31

Which proposed language is private in Wittgenstein's strict target sense?

A. A natural language whose only remaining fluent speaker applies inherited words in publicly learnable ways. B. Signs whose meanings are fixed by sensations accessible in principle only to one speaker and unteachable to others. C. A person silently rehearsing ordinary sentences that other competent speakers

could understand if they heard them. D. A cipher used by one agent today but constructed from a public language and decipherable with the key.

MCQ 32

Why does the diary sign 'S' fail to acquire a private meaning?

A. The diary is written rather than spoken, and only vocal expressions can participate in language-games. B. No independent standard distinguishes remembering the same sensation correctly from merely seeming to remember it correctly. C. The diarist cannot pronounce a one-letter sign clearly enough for it to function as a word in any language. D. Sensations change too quickly for memory, although a person with perfect memory could create the private rule.

MCQ 33

What is established by the phrase 'whatever seems right to me is right' in the diary case?

A. Every first-person avowal is false because no speaker can compare an inner state with another person's state. B. Private certainty is the highest possible standard and therefore makes the sign more secure than public expressions. C. The distinction between correct and apparently correct application has collapsed, so talk of a rule loses its point. D. Public rules are valid only because most speakers happen to experience the same sensation when using a word.

MCQ 34

What is the role of the beetle-in-a-box analogy?

A. It shows that a hidden private object cannot determine the public grammar of a sensation expression. B. It establishes that inner experiences do not exist, since the imagined boxes may turn out to be empty. C. It restates the diary's memory problem and depends on each speaker checking the same private object over time. D. It proves that each person's sensation is qualitatively identical because everyone uses the same public word.

MCQ 35

How does the private-language argument bear on solipsism?

A. It accepts solipsism as true but recommends silence because private truths cannot be communicated conveniently. B. It shows that public language mirrors identical private objects in all speakers, thereby guaranteeing interpersonal certainty. C. It undermines the attempt to state a world grounded solely in private experience because the required private signs lack standards. D. It proves by observation that other minds exist and therefore refutes every metaphysical form of idealism.

MCQ 36

Does the private-language argument deny that a solitary person can follow rules?

A. No, solitude is compatible with rules learned or sustained through public-type criteria and repeatable techniques. B. Yes, because every language requires simultaneous conversation between at least two living speakers. C. No, because private conviction replaces training once a person becomes physically isolated from society. D. Yes, another observer must watch each application for any rule to exist at that moment.

MCQ 37

Which objection most seriously tests the private-language argument from within its own concerns?

A. The argument is false because introspection always reveals exactly the same qualitative state whenever a word recurs. B. The argument fails because secret military codes are routinely spoken by only one authorized operator. C. Private sensations cannot be weighed on laboratory scales, so their existence should be rejected as scientifically meaningless. D. A solitary speaker may preserve stable criteria through memory and practice, challenging whether social publicity is necessary.

MCQ 38

Which conclusion about inner experience follows from the private-language argument?

A. Inner experience remains real and cannot alone fix the grammar and correctness of sensation words. B. Inner experience is unreal because only outwardly observable behaviour may exist within a scientific ontology. C. Inner experience directly supplies private meanings, although those meanings become public only through translation. D. Inner experience is unknowable to the subject because first-person avowals require third-person behavioural evidence.

MCQ 39

How does a criterion differ from a symptom in Wittgenstein's philosophy of psychology?

A. A criterion proves the presence of a state infallibly, while a symptom is always weak and dispensable evidence. B. A criterion belongs to the grammar of applying a concept, while a symptom is an empirically discovered correlation. C. A criterion is accessible only to the subject, while a symptom is any behaviour visible to another person. D. A criterion is simply a symptom observed more frequently and with greater statistical reliability over time.

MCQ 40

Why does the defeasibility of pain criteria matter to the charge of behaviourism?

A. Because criteria sometimes fail, sensation words must ultimately be grounded in private ostensive definitions. B. Pain behaviour can be pretended or suppressed, so its criterial role does not make pain identical with behaviour. C. Pretence proves that first-person avowals are observational reports inferred from the speaker's own bodily movements. D. Defeasibility shows that behaviour is irrelevant to pain concepts and may be removed from their grammar entirely within psychological discourse.

MCQ 41

What does 'An inner process stands in need of outward criteria' most plausibly mean?

A. A subject knows pain by observing personal behaviour and inferring an inaccessible inner cause. B. Only outward movements exist, while references to inner processes are false scientific hypotheses within a completed materialist psychology. C. Every genuine inner episode must produce one unique behaviour that establishes it with certainty. D. Meaningful psychological discourse is grammatically anchored to public circumstances without denying inner processes.

MCQ 42

How should the first-person utterance 'I am in pain' normally be classified?

A. It is meaningless because the speaker alone has access to the sensation named by the word pain. B. It functions as an avowal or learned expression of pain rather than a report inferred from behavioural criteria. C. The utterance is a hypothesis about a private object confirmed by comparing one's present behaviour with previous observations. D. The utterance is a third-person description abbreviated for convenience and governed by precisely the same evidential route.

MCQ 43

Which position best describes Wittgenstein's middle route in philosophy of mind?

A. He eliminates sensations in favour of observable movements and treats first-person speech as theoretically dispensable. B. He makes each community's majority response constitutive of whether an individual genuinely experiences pain. C. He rejects private-object semantics and reductive behaviourism while retaining inner life and defeasible public criteria. D. He accepts Cartesian private objects but supplements them with behaviour as indirect evidence for other minds.

MCQ 44

What diagnosis is expressed by the phrase 'language goes on holiday'?

A. Speakers cease communicating during leisure, so philosophy must study language only in professional institutions. B. Natural language temporarily stops changing, allowing an ideal logical notation to replace it without loss. C. Every metaphor becomes meaningless whenever it departs from literal description of an observable fact. D. A word is detached from the ordinary practices that give it work, generating a misleading philosophical appearance.

MCQ 45

What is a perspicuous or surveyable representation intended to achieve?

A. It rearranges familiar uses so their connections become visible and a specific conceptual confusion can dissolve. B. It derives hidden metaphysical entities from ordinary sentences through a complete formal proof. C. It records statistically dominant usage and declares minority practices incorrect by definition. D. It translates every language-game into one ideal notation whose logical form supplies its genuine meaning.

MCQ 46

How should 'philosophy leaves everything as it is' be interpreted?

A. Science supplies all truths, while philosophy merely repeats verified findings without conceptual analysis. B. Philosophical work is impossible, since any description would interfere with language and count as a forbidden thesis. C. Philosophy must endorse every social institution and moral practice because criticism always misuses language. D. Philosophy does not reform ordinary grammar through theory and can change our view by dissolving confusion.

MCQ 47

What is the force of the fly-bottle image?

A. Ordinary speakers are irrational insects whose mistakes require correction by an expert scientific language. B. A philosophical theory should trap every possible objection inside a deductively closed system of propositions. C. Therapy helps a thinker retrace the linguistic route into confusion until the apparent problem loses its grip. D. The image proves that all philosophical questions are meaningless under the verification principle.

MCQ 48

What does the duck-rabbit illustrate in the discussion of aspect-seeing?

A. The physical drawing changes whenever attention shifts, so perception faithfully records a new external object. B. Seeing an aspect is merely an inference stated after neutral perception and never belongs to visual experience. C. Only private images determine which animal is seen, making aspect reports instances of essentially private language. D. The unchanged figure can be experienced under different aspects, revealing perception shaped by conceptual mastery.

MCQ 49

Which statement respects the ownership boundary for aspect-seeing and On Certainty?

A. They are bounded enrichments that may sharpen answers without displacing the three printed syllabus limbs. B. They are directly examined in every Later Wittgenstein PYQ and therefore replace detailed study of language-games. C. Aspect-seeing is a doctrine of the Tractatus because the duck-rabbit pictures two possible atomic facts simultaneously. D. Hinge certainty belongs to Topic 06 because Moore's propositions are discussed, so later analysis should never appear here.

MCQ 50

Can words generally be identified with ideas in the mind of the person who uses them?

A. Yes, provided speakers report their ideas sincerely, since sincerity supplies a complete semantic rule. B. Yes, because each meaningful word names one introspectible idea whose recurrence guarantees the same application. C. No, because mental imagery never occurs and all psychological language should be eliminated in favour of behaviour. D. No, private ideas may accompany speech without determining correct use, which depends on techniques and criteria within language-games.

MCQ 51

Which overall judgement best integrates the strengths and limits of Later Wittgenstein's project?

A. It proves all metaphysical claims false by applying one universal criterion of cognitive meaning to every sentence. B. It powerfully exposes semantic myths through practice, with unresolved questions about normativity, quietism and forms of life. C. It supplies a complete empirical science of language whose predictions eliminate the need for philosophical criticism. D. It makes meaning whatever communities happen to approve and therefore abolishes rational criticism across practices.